The King Arrives

Mark 1–2 · Luke 4:16–21 · Matthew 5:1–16

The big idea: Jesus announced that the kingdom of God had arrived in him. He called ordinary fishermen, touched a leper, ate with sinners, and blessed the poor in spirit. The kingdom is upside down: the way in is down.

Before you meet: Read

Mark 1:14–20, 40–42 | Mark 2:13–17 | Matthew 5:1–16

Open (5 minutes)

If you could change one thing about how the world works, what would it be?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"The time is fulfilled, and the kingdom of God is at hand; _____ and believe in the gospel." *(Mark 1:15)*

"Those who are well have no need of a _____, but those who are sick." *(Mark 2:17)*

"Blessed are the _____ in spirit, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven." *(Matthew 5:3)*

Discuss

1. Jesus touched a leper and ate with sinners. Who are the people everyone avoids in your world? What would it look like to move toward them? *Mark 1:40–42; 2:15–17*

2. Read the Beatitudes. Which one surprises you most? Which one do you most need? *Matthew 5:3–10*

3. Jesus said, "whoever would be great among you must be your servant." Where does that turn your ambitions upside down? *Mark 10:43–44*

Memory verse

> *"But seek first the kingdom of God and his righteousness, and all these things will be added to you."*
>
> **Matthew 6:33**

Pray

Come to God poor in spirit, with nothing but your need. Ask Jesus to make you someone who moves toward the people others avoid.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 39

The King Arrives

Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Mark 1:14–20, 40–42 and Matthew 5:1–12 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Matthew 6–7 and 13:31–46).

Main points to land

1. Jesus' first message was the kingdom of God: God's saving rule arriving in his Son (Mark 1:15; Colossians 1:13).
2. Jesus showed the kingdom by calling ordinary people, healing, and welcoming outcasts and sinners (Mark 1:17, 41; 2:17).
3. The kingdom is upside down. It belongs to the poor in spirit, and greatness means serving (Matthew 5:3–10; Mark 10:43–45).

Answer key (Observe)

1. repent
2. physician
3. poor

Questions people will ask

Is the kingdom of God a political program?
No. The kingdom is God's saving rule through his Son. Jesus said his kingdom is not of this world (John 18:36). It changes how citizens live in every area of life, including how they treat the poor and their neighbors, but it advances through the gospel and new hearts, not through a party or a nation.

Closing prayer

Lord Jesus, you came to the sick and the outcast and the sinner, and you came to us. We come poor in spirit, with nothing to bring. Make us citizens of your kingdom, and teach us to serve as you served. Amen.